

Magic Wand

 Logging on to Web sites is a much simpler task thanks to the Wand feature—a password and forms manager. Log in to a site and let Opera save your username and password. When you next come to the same site, the login boxes will be bordered golden. Press [Ctrl] + [Enter] at the login



screen and Opera fills in the requisite personal information, and automatically log in. All Wand passwords can be cleared from 'Delete private data' on the File menu. Your usernames and passwords are scrambled by the Wand before they are saved to disk. However, for added protection you may set a master password in Opera's Security preferences. Press [Alt] + [P] and go to the Security section of the Preferences dialog box. Click on 'Set password' next to 'Master password' for added security. You can also change it when Opera asks you for the password, and when it asks whether the same should be used for both the e-mail client and the Wand.

Search Me

 Opera supports several search engines. You can either type in a query into the search field—[Shift] + [F8]—or you can use the Address Bar to do the same. Every engine is associated with a single letter; thus, Google gets a 'g',

Download.com gets a 'w', etc. Press [Alt] + [P] and go to the Search option for the list of engines supported and the associated letter. Here, you can also change the number of results displayed per page. To use the Address Bar for a Google search, press [F8] and precede a query with a 'g,' for example, 'g X-Men movie Web site' [Enter], will search for the 'X-Men...' string in Google.

Forward/Rewind

 When viewing a page with no user forward history, Opera will try to detect a possible forward link that you can access. The Forward icon will change into a FastForward icon when this is possible.

Certain Web sites, mostly forums and search engines, have a single link at the bottom that takes you to the next page of posts. Try it with a search engine to go to the Next page link, or when reading a multi-page article.

It can detect link-next elements, and will perform checks to find one if not. Press the spacebar to follow the link to the next post, or page. Rewind takes you back to a site in the history. If you have jumped from Google.com to Thinkdigit.com, you can rewind to Google by pressing [Shift] + [Z]. Rewind takes you back a Web site, so unless you have followed more than one link at Thinkdigit.com, you can press [Shift] + [Z] to go instantly back to Google.

Pressing [Z], on the other hand, would take you just one page back. Note that [Shift] + [X] takes you forward in a similar vein.

Slideshow

 In a Web site that has a lot of images linked in a

continuous manner (for example, a site that displays family photos or screenshots of games), you can use the Slideshow feature of Opera to enjoy the pictures better. The FastForward button displays photo files on the Web in a



slideshow. To see photos full-screen on a black background, press [F11] to invoke Opera's presentation tool, OperaShow.

Reload Time

 Opera can reload a Web site after a user-specified time. Right-click on a Web page and go to **Reload every > Enable**. Note that you can also set a custom time, to reload at, say, every two minutes and 30 seconds.

The Custom dialog box also lets you reload only if the Web page has expired (as determined by the site programmer). Great for those cricket score Web sites!

By Proxy

 To set up a proxy server, press [Alt] + [P] > **Network > Proxy Servers**. Add the address and port number for the appropriate type of the proxy server here, and just make sure that the checkbox is ticked. You can also disable proxies for certain addresses, such as within a LAN, and can point Opera to an automatic proxy configuration URL, in case your ISP requires such a setting.

Bet You Didn't Know

Mouse Gestures in Opera

Mouse gestures are a novel way to navigate the Web using Opera. For instance, you can hold the right mouse button and draw an 'L' on a Web page to indicate that you want it closed. Similarly, right-click and hold the mouse over a link and move it down and then up to open the link in the background window. Here are some gestures supported by Opera. Click and hold the right mouse button, move the mouse in the directions indicated below and then release the button:

- ☐ Open new document: Move down
- ☐ Reload: Move up and down
- ☐ Restore or maximise window: Move up then right
- ☐ Minimise: Move down then left
- ☐ Duplicate window: Move down then up
- ☐ Close document: Move down then right, or move right-left-right



Note it Down

 Opera lets you keep snippets of text from Web sites as notes. For example, a particularly interesting piece of news can be saved for posterity as a note. To do this, select any amount of text off a Web page, right-click and click on 'Copy to note' ([Ctrl] + [Shift] + [C]). Notes can then be accessed by pressing the [F4] key, to invoke the Hotlist under the Notes section. You can delete notes here

no more excuses!

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